Fiber cable and equipment safety

Article: NF-EQ-004 | **Owner:** Network Equipment
Category: equipment | **Topic:** optical_and_electrical_safety
Audience: customer_assistant | **Applies to:** NovaFiber residential optical installation and supplied equipment
Reviewed: 2026-10-07 | **Next review:** 2027-01-07
Related articles: NF-TS-002, NF-EQ-001, NF-GF-002

1. Leave optical work to technicians

NovaFiber customers may visually observe an accessible cable route from a safe position. Customers must not unplug, reseat, clean, inspect, or repair an optical connector; remove a protective cap; look into an optical port; splice fiber; or open an ONT. Optical connectors can carry invisible light, and damaged fiber fragments are not suitable for household handling. Do not use an optical test meter or attempt improvised cleaning.

2. Prevent ordinary cable damage

Keep fiber away from doors, chair wheels, sharp furniture edges, pets, and places where it could be pulled or crushed. Do not staple, tightly tie, twist, sharply bend, or place heavy objects on the cable. Do not prescribe a universal bend radius: the installed cable's specification controls it. If a room change needs a different fiber route, request authorized assistance rather than extending or rerouting the fiber yourself.

3. Recognize stop conditions

For exposed or broken fiber, crushed cable, liquid exposure, burning smell, sparks, damaged power adapters, or unsafe electrical access, stop troubleshooting and keep people and pets away. Do not touch fragments, sweep them by hand, open equipment, or climb into building wiring spaces. If it is safe to do so using an accessible dry power switch, switch off affected equipment; leave optical connectors untouched. For smoke, fire, or immediate danger, contact local emergency services before routine broadband support.

4. Safe observation and reporting

From a safe position, record the device model, visible cable condition, and LED states. A photograph may show the cable route without handling it; exclude account codes and full credential labels. Contact verified NovaFiber support to describe the issue and location. Red LOS is a symptom of signal loss, not a command to unplug the fiber. Support determines whether a network fault, site repair, or equipment replacement is appropriate.

5. Power and ventilation precautions

Use only the supplied or provider-approved power adapter for each device. Keep equipment dry and ventilated, with vents clear. Do not open power supplies, repair household wiring, daisy-chain damaged power accessories, or use an adapter with an unknown voltage. A normal controlled restart operates only power switches or adapters when they are safe to access; it never requires disturbing optical fiber. When in doubt about safe handling, stop and ask for qualified help.

6. Moves and service visits

Moving the router using an Ethernet cable may be possible without moving the ONT; ask support if cabling or coverage is unclear. Moving the installed ONT or fiber termination requires authorized work. Service relocation is covered in NF-GF-002. A visit or replacement charge depends on the applicable published policy and diagnosis, not the mere presence of a safety concern. Nova can explain these rules but cannot assess electrical safety remotely or book an emergency repair.